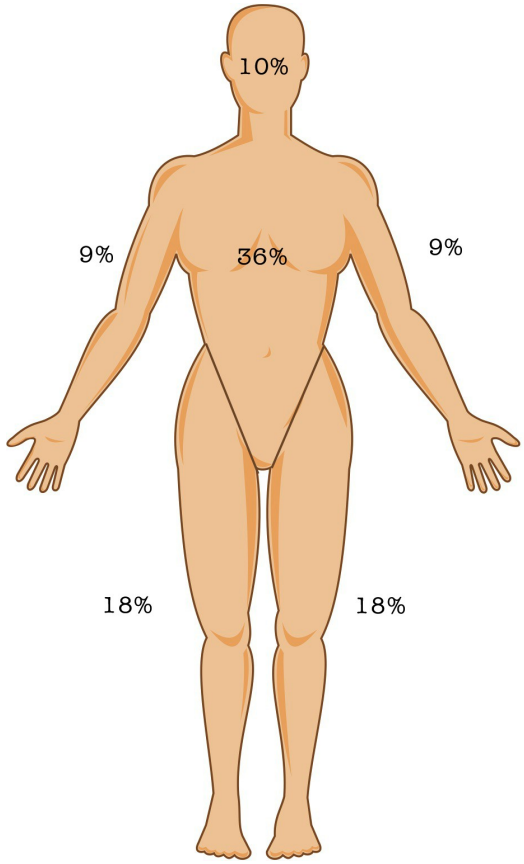
The rule of nines is a method of roughly estimating the percentage of the body's surface area that has suffered a burn and that divides the body into easy-to-remember groups of 9 or multiples of 9. A major burn is considered to be a second-degree burn that covers at least 25% of the body's surface area or a third-degree burn that covers at least 10%.

For example, a patient who has burns of both arms and the front of the torso would have a burn that covers approximately 36% of the body's surface area (each arm is 9% and the front of the torso is another 18%).



Nagelhout JJ, Plaus K. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 902.

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